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with time. Such a motion is said to be an accelerated motion.

i) In accelerated motion, if the change in velocity of an object per unit time is same (constant) then the object is said to be moving with uniformly accelerated motion.
ii) On the other hand, if the change in velocity per unit time is different at different times, then the object is said to be moving with non-uniform accelerated motion.

Average acceleration

If an object changes its velocity from $\vec{v}_1$ to $\vec{v}_2$ in a time interval $\Delta t = t_2 - t_1$, then the average acceleration is defined as the ratio of change in velocity over the time interval $\Delta t = t_2 - t_1$

$$\vec{a}_{avg} = \frac{\vec{v}_2 - \vec{v}_1}{t_2 - t_1} = \frac{\Delta \vec{v}}{\Delta t}$$

Average acceleration is a vector quantity in the same direction as the vector Δv.

Instantaneous acceleration

Usually, the average acceleration will give the change in velocity only over the entire time interval. It will not give value of the acceleration at any instant time t.

Instantaneous acceleration or acceleration of a particle at time 't' is given by the ratio of change in velocity over Δt, as Δt approaches zero.

$$\text{Acceleration } \vec{a} = \lim_{\Delta t \to 0} \frac{\Delta \vec{v}}{\Delta t} = \frac{d\vec{v}}{dt}$$

In other words, the acceleration of the particle at an instant t is equal to rate of change of velocity.

(i) Acceleration is a vector quantity. Its SI unit is ms^{-2} and its dimensional formula is $M^0L^1T^{-2}$
(ii) Acceleration is positive if its velocity is increasing, and is negative if the velocity is decreasing. The negative acceleration is called retardation or deceleration.

In terms of components, we can write

$$\vec{a} = \frac{dv_x}{dt}\hat{i} + \frac{dv_y}{dt}\hat{j} + \frac{dv_z}{dt}\hat{k} = \frac{d\vec{v}}{dt}$$

Thus $a_x = \frac{dv_x}{dt}$, $a_y = \frac{dv_y}{dt}$, $a_z = \frac{dv_z}{dt}$ are the components of instantaneous acceleration.

Since each component of velocity is the derivative of the corresponding coordinate, we can express the components a_x, a_y, and a_z, as

$$a_x = \frac{d^2x}{dt^2}, \quad a_y = \frac{d^2y}{dt^2}, \quad a_z = \frac{d^2z}{dt^2}$$

Then the acceleration vector $\vec{a}$ itself is

$$\vec{a} = \frac{d^2x}{dt^2}\hat{i} + \frac{d^2y}{dt^2}\hat{j} + \frac{d^2z}{dt^2}\hat{k} = \frac{d^2\vec{r}}{dt^2}$$

Thus acceleration is the second derivative of position vector with respect to time.

Graphically the acceleration is the slope in the velocity-time graph. At the same time if the acceleration-time graph is given, then the velocity can be found from the area under the acceleration-time graph.

From $\frac{dv}{dt} = a$, we have $dv = a\,dt$; hence

$$v = \int_{t_1}^{t_2} a\,dt$$

For an initial time t_1 and final time t_2